

FIELD EDITION / SOUTHERN_TASMANIA / 2026

2026 observing almanac

HORIZON	EDITION	SCOPE
Southern Tasmania, Australia	2026	Night planning, Moon, Galactic Centre, planets and events

Priority observations

NO.	DATE	CATEGORY	OBSERVATION	RATING
01	28 Mar 2026	Milky Way	Milky Way core window 5h 23m with 76° altitude.	EXCELLENT
02	10 Nov 2026	Minor planets	4 Vesta 52° altitude; magnitude 6.9.	EXCELLENT
03	3 Mar 2026	Eclipses	Total lunar eclipse Visible at maximum; umbral magnitude 1.15.	EXCELLENT
04	31 May 2026	Planets	Neptune Best monthly date at 45° altitude.	EXCELLENT
05	31 Mar 2026	Comets	Comet 43P 53° altitude; magnitude 17.2.	GOOD
06	12 Aug 2026	Meteor showers	Perseids Peak conditions: 4% Moon illumination; -14° altitude predawn.	GOOD

Monthly sheets give local dates and times. CSV tables: [data/index.html](#).

ANNUAL INDEX

Annual summary

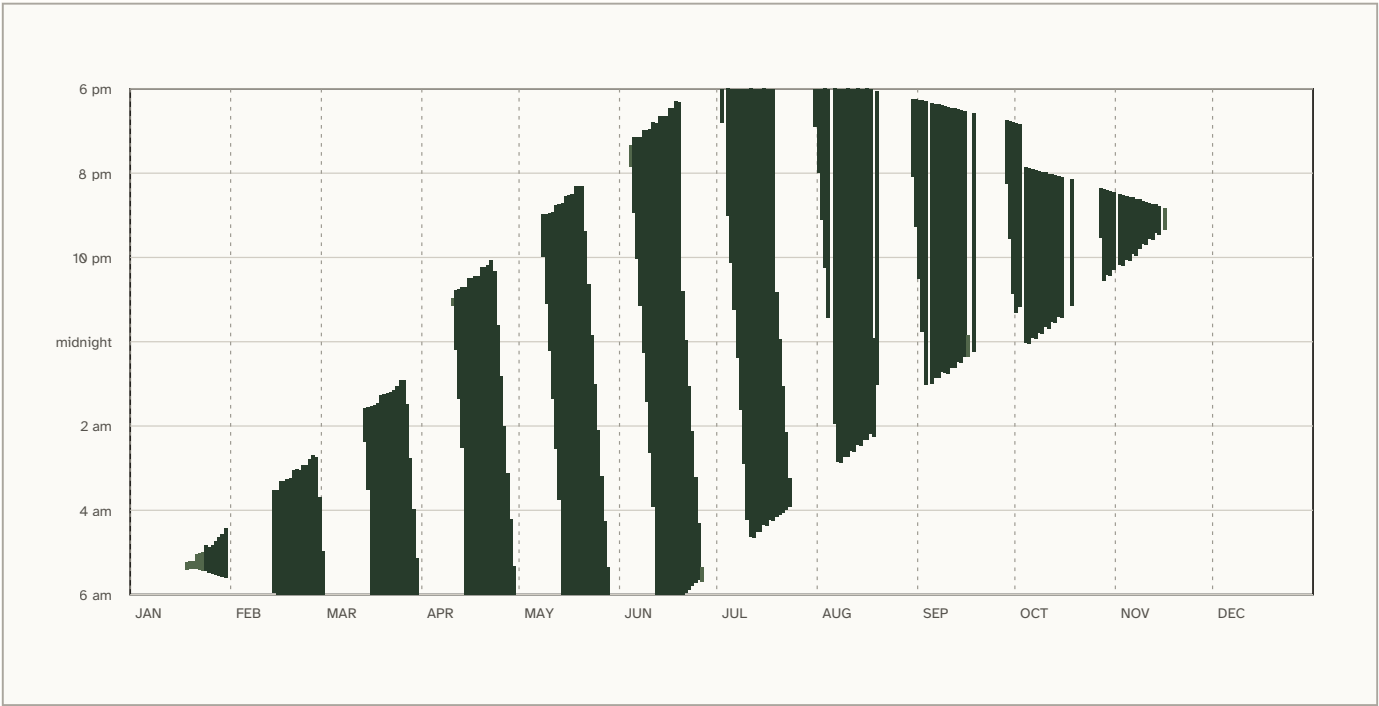
The principal observing lead, darkest low-Moon interval and darkest lunar date for each month.

MONTH	EVENT OR TARGET	BEST LOW-MOON DARKNESS	DARKEST MOON	RATING
01 JANUARY	PLANET OPPOSITION Jupiter reaches opposition on 11 Jan 2026 and is highest around 1:30 am.	23 Jan 2026 · 8h 06m	Darkest Moon 19 Jan 2026 · 0% illuminated	FAIR
02 FEBRUARY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 28 Feb 2026, from 3:41 am to 6:18 am, reaching 60°.	21 Feb 2026 · 9h 27m	Darkest Moon 18 Feb 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
03 MARCH	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 27 Mar 2026, from 1:29 am to 6:51 am, reaching 76°.	23 Mar 2026 · 10h 58m	Darkest Moon 19 Mar 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
04 APRIL	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 20 Apr 2026, from 10:13 pm to 6:18 am, reaching 76°.	21 Apr 2026 · 12h 18m	Darkest Moon 18 Apr 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
05 MAY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 19 May 2026, from 8:19 pm to 6:47 am, reaching 76°.	20 May 2026 · 13h 20m	Darkest Moon 17 May 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
06 JUNE	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 14 Jun 2026, from 6:38 pm to 6:28 am, reaching 76°.	19 Jun 2026 · 13h 49m	Darkest Moon 15 Jun 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
07 JULY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 14 Jul 2026, from 5:30 pm to 4:30 am, reaching 76°.	11 Jul 2026 · 13h 38m	Darkest Moon 15 Jul 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
08 AUGUST	METEOR SHOWER Perseids peak on 12 Aug 2026 under 4% Moon, though the radiant stays low from this horizon.	10 Aug 2026 · 12h 46m	Darkest Moon 13 Aug 2026 · 1% illuminated	GOOD
09 SEPTEMBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Neptune reaches opposition on 26 Sep 2026 and is highest around 12:00 am.	8 Sep 2026 · 11h 33m	Darkest Moon 11 Sep 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
10 OCTOBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Saturn reaches opposition on 5 Oct 2026 and is highest around 1:00 am.	7 Oct 2026 · 10h 09m	Darkest Moon 11 Oct 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
11 NOVEMBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Uranus reaches opposition on 26 Nov 2026 and is highest around 1:00 am.	6 Nov 2026 · 8h 40m	Darkest Moon 9 Nov 2026 · 0% illuminated	GOOD
12 DECEMBER	PLANETS Neptune: Best monthly date at 48° altitude.	5 Dec 2026 · 7h 36m	Darkest Moon 9 Dec 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT

ANNUAL NIGHT CHART

Galactic Centre observing time

Each vertical trace is a usable core-viewing interval. Dates run left to right; local night time runs downward from 6 pm to 6 am.



Only intervals that pass astronomical darkness, Moon and core-altitude constraints are shown.

Best session by month

MONTH	DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALTITUDE	RATING
January	30 Jan 2026	4:25 am to 5:36 am	1h 12m	32°	EXCELLENT
February	26 Feb 2026	2:41 am to 6:15 am	3h 35m	58°	EXCELLENT
March	26 Mar 2026	12:54 am to 6:50 am	5h 57m	76°	EXCELLENT
April	22 Apr 2026	10:04 pm to 6:20 am	8h 16m	76°	EXCELLENT
May	20 May 2026	8:18 pm to 6:48 am	10h 30m	76°	EXCELLENT
June	14 Jun 2026	6:38 pm to 6:28 am	11h 50m	76°	EXCELLENT
July	11 Jul 2026	5:28 pm to 4:38 am	11h 10m	76°	EXCELLENT
August	8 Aug 2026	5:52 pm to 2:52 am	9h 00m	76°	EXCELLENT
September	3 Sep 2026	6:18 pm to 1:02 am	6h 43m	76°	EXCELLENT
October	1 Oct 2026	6:49 pm to 11:19 pm	4h 30m	67°	EXCELLENT
November	2 Nov 2026	8:30 pm to 10:10 pm	1h 40m	37°	EXCELLENT
December	No qualifying session				

MONTH 01

January 2026

FAIR

Jupiter reaches opposition on 11 Jan 2026 and is highest around 1:30 am.

NEW MOON 19 Jan 2026	FULL MOON 4 Jan 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jan 2026	DARKNESS 9:26 pm to 5:15 am
-------------------------	-------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
23 Jan 2026	9:20 pm to 5:26 am	8h 06m	20%
22 Jan 2026	9:21 pm to 5:25 am	8h 04m	12%
21 Jan 2026	9:22 pm to 5:23 am	8h 02m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
30 Jan 2026	4:25 am to 5:36 am	1h 12m	32°	EXCELLENT
29 Jan 2026	4:35 am to 5:35 am	1h 00m	32°	EXCELLENT
28 Jan 2026	4:38 am to 5:33 am	56m	30°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	1 Jan 9:30 pm	32°	GOOD
Evening	Saturn	1 Jan 9:30 pm	32°	GOOD
Evening	Uranus	12 Jan 9:30 pm	28°	GOOD
Overnight	Jupiter	1 Jan 2:00 am	25°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	1 Jan 5:00 am	2°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
10 Jan 2026	Planetary events	Jupiter opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
1 Jan 2026	Minor planets	1 Ceres	27° altitude; magnitude 8.9.	FAIR
1 Jan 2026	Occultations	HIP 22400 lunar occultation	11:19 pm; Moon at 19° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 02

February 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 28 Feb 2026, from 3:41 am to 6:18 am, reaching 60°.

NEW MOON 18 Feb 2026	FULL MOON 2 Feb 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Feb 2026	DARKNESS 8:51 pm to 6:00 am
-------------------------	-------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
21 Feb 2026	8:41 pm to 6:08 am	9h 27m	16%
20 Feb 2026	8:43 pm to 6:07 am	9h 24m	9%
19 Feb 2026	8:44 pm to 6:06 am	9h 21m	4%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
26 Feb 2026	2:41 am to 6:15 am	3h 35m	58°	EXCELLENT
27 Feb 2026	2:44 am to 6:17 am	3h 33m	60°	EXCELLENT
25 Feb 2026	2:47 am to 6:14 am	3h 27m	57°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Uranus	1 Feb 9:00 pm	27°	GOOD
Evening	Saturn	1 Feb 9:00 pm	17°	FAIR
Evening	Neptune	1 Feb 9:00 pm	17°	FAIR
Evening	Mercury	20 Feb 8:30 pm	2°	POOR
Evening	Venus	20 Feb 8:30 pm	2°	POOR
Overnight	Jupiter	2 Feb 11:30 pm	25°	FAIR
Predawn	Mars	27 Feb 6:30 am	7°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
20 Feb 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest eastern elongation	Evening sky; 18.1° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Feb 2026	Occultations	HIP 37704 lunar occultation	12:46 am to 1:53 am; Moon at 21° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
1 Feb 2026	Occultations	HIP 37848 lunar occultation	1:23 am to 2:14 am; Moon at 20° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 03

March 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 27 Mar 2026, from 1:29 am to 6:51 am, reaching 76°.

NEW MOON 19 Mar 2026	FULL MOON 4 Mar 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Mar 2026	DARKNESS 8:03 pm to 6:37 am
-------------------------	-------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
23 Mar 2026	7:49 pm to 6:47 am	10h 58m	22%
22 Mar 2026	7:51 pm to 6:45 am	10h 55m	14%
21 Mar 2026	7:53 pm to 6:44 am	10h 52m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
26 Mar 2026	12:54 am to 6:50 am	5h 57m	76°	EXCELLENT
25 Mar 2026	12:54 am to 6:49 am	5h 56m	76°	EXCELLENT
24 Mar 2026	1:03 am to 6:48 am	5h 45m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	27 Mar 8:00 pm	24°	FAIR
Evening	Uranus	1 Mar 8:30 pm	21°	FAIR
Evening	Venus	27 Mar 7:30 pm	4°	POOR
Evening	Saturn	1 Mar 8:30 pm	4°	POOR
Evening	Neptune	1 Mar 8:30 pm	3°	POOR
Predawn	Mercury	31 Mar 7:00 am	20°	FAIR
Predawn	Mars	23 Mar 7:00 am	12°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
3 Mar 2026	Eclipses	Total lunar eclipse	Visible at maximum; umbral magnitude 1.15.	EXCELLENT
23 Mar 2026	Minor planets	7 Iris	45° altitude; magnitude 9.5.	GOOD
31 Mar 2026	Comets	Comet 43P	53° altitude; magnitude 17.2.	GOOD

MONTH 04

April 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 20 Apr 2026, from 10:13 pm to 6:18 am, reaching 76°.

NEW MOON 18 Apr 2026	FULL MOON 2 Apr 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Apr 2026	DARKNESS 6:10 pm to 6:12 am
-------------------------	-------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
21 Apr 2026	6:01 pm to 6:19 am	12h 18m	19%
20 Apr 2026	6:03 pm to 6:18 am	12h 15m	11%
19 Apr 2026	6:04 pm to 6:17 am	12h 13m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
22 Apr 2026	10:04 pm to 6:20 am	8h 16m	76°	EXCELLENT
21 Apr 2026	10:11 pm to 6:19 am	8h 08m	76°	EXCELLENT
20 Apr 2026	10:13 pm to 6:18 am	8h 05m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	14 Apr 6:00 pm	24°	FAIR
Evening	Uranus	1 Apr 7:30 pm	14°	POOR
Evening	Venus	14 Apr 6:00 pm	6°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	30 Apr 6:30 am	27°	GOOD
Predawn	Saturn	30 Apr 6:30 am	22°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	1 Apr 7:00 am	20°	FAIR
Predawn	Mars	19 Apr 6:30 am	16°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
8 Apr 2026	Minor planets	15 Eunomia	61° altitude; magnitude 10.0.	EXCELLENT
9 Apr 2026	Comets	Comet 29P	49° altitude; magnitude 17.4.	GOOD
4 Apr 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 27.8° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 05

May 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 19 May 2026, from 8:19 pm to 6:47 am, reaching 76°.

NEW MOON 17 May 2026	FULL MOON 2 May 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 May 2026	DARKNESS 5:32 pm to 6:43 am
-------------------------	-------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
20 May 2026	5:28 pm to 6:48 am	13h 20m	16%
19 May 2026	5:29 pm to 6:47 am	13h 18m	9%
18 May 2026	5:29 pm to 6:46 am	13h 17m	3%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
20 May 2026	8:18 pm to 6:48 am	10h 30m	76°	EXCELLENT
19 May 2026	8:19 pm to 6:47 am	10h 28m	76°	EXCELLENT
18 May 2026	8:19 pm to 6:46 am	10h 27m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	5 May 5:30 pm	24°	FAIR
Evening	Venus	31 May 5:30 pm	12°	POOR
Evening	Uranus	5 May 5:30 pm	4°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	31 May 7:00 am	45°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	31 May 7:00 am	40°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	18 May 7:00 am	20°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	1 May 6:30 am	8°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
2 May 2026	Occultations	HIP 73927 lunar occultation	8:39 pm to 9:45 pm; Moon at 37° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
6 May 2026	Meteor showers	Eta Aquariids	Peak conditions: 88% Moon illumination; 24° altitude predawn.	POOR
3 May 2026	Occultations	HIP 77858 lunar occultation	6:52 pm to 7:35 pm; Moon at 12° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 06

June 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 14 Jun 2026, from 6:38 pm to 6:28 am, reaching 76°.

NEW MOON 15 Jun 2026	FULL MOON 1 Jun 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jun 2026	DARKNESS 5:18 pm to 7:06 am
-------------------------	-------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
19 Jun 2026	5:19 pm to 7:07 am	13h 49m	22%
18 Jun 2026	5:18 pm to 7:07 am	13h 48m	14%
17 Jun 2026	5:18 pm to 7:07 am	13h 48m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
14 Jun 2026	6:38 pm to 6:28 am	11h 50m	76°	EXCELLENT
19 Jun 2026	6:19 pm to 6:09 am	11h 50m	76°	EXCELLENT
16 Jun 2026	6:28 pm to 6:18 am	11h 50m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	30 Jun 5:30 pm	22°	FAIR
Evening	Jupiter	1 Jun 5:30 pm	19°	FAIR
Evening	Mercury	22 Jun 5:30 pm	9°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	14 Jun 7:00 am	47°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	23 Jun 7:00 am	44°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	1 Jun 7:00 am	19°	FAIR
Predawn	Uranus	30 Jun 7:00 am	16°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
6 Jun 2026	Comets	Comet 24P	51° altitude; magnitude 17.8.	GOOD
16 Jun 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest eastern elongation	Evening sky; 24.5° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Jun 2026	Occultations	HIP 81821 lunar occultation	1:34 am to 2:22 am; Moon at 68° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 07

July 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 14 Jul 2026, from 5:30 pm to 4:30 am, reaching 76°.

NEW MOON 15 Jul 2026	FULL MOON 30 Jul 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jul 2026	DARKNESS 5:31 pm to 7:04 am
-------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
11 Jul 2026	5:28 pm to 7:06 am	13h 38m	24%
12 Jul 2026	5:29 pm to 7:06 am	13h 37m	15%
13 Jul 2026	5:30 pm to 7:05 am	13h 35m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
11 Jul 2026	5:28 pm to 4:38 am	11h 10m	76°	EXCELLENT
12 Jul 2026	5:29 pm to 4:39 am	11h 10m	76°	EXCELLENT
14 Jul 2026	5:30 pm to 4:30 am	11h 00m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	29 Jul 5:30 pm	34°	GOOD
Evening	Jupiter	1 Jul 5:30 pm	8°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	31 Jul 4:00 am	47°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	1 Jul 6:30 am	44°	GOOD
Predawn	Uranus	31 Jul 7:00 am	25°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 Jul 7:00 am	18°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	31 Jul 7:00 am	7°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
8 Jul 2026	Comets	Comet 3D	61° altitude; magnitude 16.4.	GOOD
1 Jul 2026	Occultations	HIP 93963 lunar occultation	12:27 am to 1:19 am; Moon at 73° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
8 Jul 2026	Planetary events	Neptune stationary point	Apparent motion changes direction.	FAIR

MONTH 08

August 2026

GOOD

Perseids peak on 12 Aug 2026 under 4% Moon, though the radiant stays low from this horizon.

NEW MOON 13 Aug 2026	FULL MOON 29 Aug 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Aug 2026	DARKNESS 5:59 pm to 6:34 am
-------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
10 Aug 2026	5:54 pm to 6:40 am	12h 46m	17%
11 Aug 2026	5:55 pm to 6:39 am	12h 44m	10%
12 Aug 2026	5:56 pm to 6:38 am	12h 42m	4%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
8 Aug 2026	5:52 pm to 2:52 am	9h 00m	76°	EXCELLENT
7 Aug 2026	5:51 pm to 2:51 am	9h 00m	76°	EXCELLENT
10 Aug 2026	5:54 pm to 2:44 am	8h 50m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	28 Aug 6:00 pm	39°	GOOD
Overnight	Neptune	29 Aug 2:00 am	47°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Saturn	31 Aug 2:30 am	44°	GOOD
Predawn	Uranus	21 Aug 6:30 am	26°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	5 Aug 7:00 am	18°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	1 Aug 7:00 am	7°	POOR
Predawn	Jupiter	26 Aug 6:30 am	4°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
26 Aug 2026	Minor planets	3 Juno	55° altitude; magnitude 9.3.	EXCELLENT
12 Aug 2026	Meteor showers	Perseids	Peak conditions: 4% Moon illumination; -14° altitude predawn.	GOOD
2 Aug 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 19.5° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 09

September 2026

EXCELLENT

Neptune reaches opposition on 26 Sep 2026 and is highest around 12:00 am.

NEW MOON 11 Sep 2026	FULL MOON 27 Sep 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Sep 2026	DARKNESS 6:31 pm to 5:44 am
-------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
8 Sep 2026	6:23 pm to 5:56 am	11h 33m	20%
9 Sep 2026	6:24 pm to 5:54 am	11h 30m	12%
10 Sep 2026	6:26 pm to 5:53 am	11h 27m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
3 Sep 2026	6:18 pm to 1:02 am	6h 43m	76°	EXCELLENT
5 Sep 2026	6:20 pm to 1:00 am	6h 40m	76°	EXCELLENT
7 Sep 2026	6:22 pm to 12:52 am	6h 30m	76°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	7 Sep 6:30 pm	34°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	25 Sep 6:30 pm	16°	FAIR
Overnight	Neptune	28 Sep 12:00 am	47°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Saturn	30 Sep 12:30 am	45°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Uranus	28 Sep 4:00 am	26°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	30 Sep 5:30 am	18°	FAIR
Predawn	Jupiter	30 Sep 5:30 am	14°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
26 Sep 2026	Planetary events	Neptune opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
2 Sep 2026	Occultations	HIP 9449 lunar occultation	12:51 am to 1:51 am; Moon at 19° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
2 Sep 2026	Occultations	HIP 9627 lunar occultation	2:16 am to 3:12 am; Moon at 26° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 10

October 2026

EXCELLENT

Saturn reaches opposition on 5 Oct 2026 and is highest around 1:00 am.

NEW MOON 11 Oct 2026	FULL MOON 26 Oct 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Oct 2026	DARKNESS 8:06 pm to 5:50 am
-------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
7 Oct 2026	7:56 pm to 6:04 am	10h 09m	22%
8 Oct 2026	7:57 pm to 6:03 am	10h 06m	14%
9 Oct 2026	7:58 pm to 6:01 am	10h 03m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
1 Oct 2026	6:49 pm to 11:19 pm	4h 30m	67°	EXCELLENT
2 Oct 2026	6:50 pm to 11:10 pm	4h 20m	66°	EXCELLENT
4 Oct 2026	7:52 pm to 12:02 am	4h 10m	65°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	1 Oct 7:00 pm	22°	FAIR
Evening	Mercury	16 Oct 8:00 pm	19°	FAIR
Overnight	Neptune	27 Oct 11:00 pm	48°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Saturn	31 Oct 11:00 pm	46°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	28 Oct 3:00 am	26°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 Oct 5:30 am	21°	FAIR
Predawn	Jupiter	31 Oct 5:30 am	21°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
3 Oct 2026	Comets	Comet 10P	80° altitude; magnitude 13.9.	GOOD
4 Oct 2026	Planetary events	Saturn opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
2 Oct 2026	Occultations	HIP 22400 lunar occultation	3:19 am to 4:38 am; Moon at 18° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 11

November 2026

GOOD

Uranus reaches opposition on 26 Nov 2026 and is highest around 1:00 am.

NEW MOON 9 Nov 2026	FULL MOON 25 Nov 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Nov 2026	DARKNESS 8:48 pm to 5:05 am
------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
6 Nov 2026	8:35 pm to 5:16 am	8h 40m	18%
7 Nov 2026	8:37 pm to 5:14 am	8h 38m	11%
8 Nov 2026	8:38 pm to 5:13 am	8h 35m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
2 Nov 2026	8:30 pm to 10:10 pm	1h 40m	37°	EXCELLENT
3 Nov 2026	8:31 pm to 10:11 pm	1h 40m	36°	EXCELLENT
4 Nov 2026	8:33 pm to 10:03 pm	1h 30m	35°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	26 Nov 9:00 pm	48°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	25 Nov 9:30 pm	46°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	27 Nov 1:00 am	27°	GOOD
Predawn	Jupiter	30 Nov 5:00 am	30°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	30 Nov 5:00 am	28°	GOOD
Predawn	Venus	30 Nov 5:00 am	13°	POOR
Predawn	Mercury	30 Nov 5:00 am	2°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
10 Nov 2026	Minor planets	4 Vesta	52° altitude; magnitude 6.9.	EXCELLENT
3 Nov 2026	Occultations	Jupiter lunar occultation	10:31 am to 11:41 am; Moon at 25° altitude for the first listed contact.	GOOD
21 Nov 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 19.6° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 12

December 2026

EXCELLENT

Neptune: Best monthly date at 48° altitude.

NEW MOON 9 Dec 2026	FULL MOON 24 Dec 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Dec 2026	DARKNESS 9:24 pm to 4:50 am
------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------

Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
5 Dec 2026	9:14 pm to 4:50 am	7h 36m	22%
6 Dec 2026	9:15 pm to 4:50 am	7h 35m	14%
7 Dec 2026	9:16 pm to 4:50 am	7h 33m	9%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
No qualifying core session is listed.				

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	1 Dec 9:00 pm	48°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	2 Dec 9:00 pm	46°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	31 Dec 10:30 pm	27°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 Dec 5:00 am	36°	GOOD
Predawn	Jupiter	23 Dec 5:00 am	34°	GOOD
Predawn	Venus	31 Dec 5:00 am	21°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	3 Dec 5:00 am	2°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
31 Dec 2026	Comets	Comet 11P	41° altitude; magnitude 17.8.	GOOD
14 Dec 2026	Meteor showers	Geminids	Peak conditions: 22% Moon illumination; 14° altitude predawn.	FAIR
5 Dec 2026	Occultations	HIP 65239 lunar occultation	3:51 am; Moon at 10° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

REFERENCE

Using this field edition

Time and place

All displayed dates and times are local to Southern Tasmania, Australia. Overnight intervals begin on the printed date and may end after midnight on the following civil date.

Ratings

Text labels repeat every colour-coded rating for monochrome printing.

Low-Moon darkness

Intervals occur within astronomical darkness and apply the edition's Moon constraint. They are not interchangeable with Galactic Centre visibility, which additionally requires the core to clear the altitude threshold.

CSV tables

Full CSV tables for twilight, Moon, Galactic Centre, planets, satellites, minor planets, comets and events are available from the web data index.

Sources and scope

- Solar, lunar, planetary and Galactic Centre circumstances are calculated for the named observing horizon.
- Jupiter and Saturn satellite positions use NASA JPL Horizons.
- Meteor and event sources are listed in the downloadable tables.
- This PDF does not include live weather, cloud, smoke, local obstruction or artificial sky brightness.

Web data index: <data/index.html>